Run the prototype

FACILITATOR ONLY | VERSION 0.2 | SPOILERS

Five players and one facilitator. Print the 15-page player pack and this pack single-sided A4 at 100%. Cut player pp. 7-12 as marked and facilitator p. 5. Grey Petrel is recorded on player p. 13; use one coin to show its availability. Bring three track counters and pens.

Briefing: eight minutes

Seat one Guild and one Janissariat delegate at each council; the Ascendant attends Security. Teammates meet together in faction phases. Explain that each round compresses one month, these are two outstanding Charter instruments, and the other institutions' consent is already arranged.

Readiness measures conditioned power, not food or virtue. Civilian opposition on Vethis is separate from the armed remnants named as targets. New asset names and the local emergency belong to this prototype. No player needs the old lore files.

Start Beacon 2, Communities 3, Readiness 3. All four faction assets are ready; Grey Petrel is unused; commercial contracts 0. Record opening article preferences. Show public consequences, including the risks of Trade, but keep the four vision cards private.

Clock	Your task
00-08	Brief, seat, distribute briefs and record preferences.
08-13	R1 faction decisions. Deal one selected vision. Lock asset assignments and reserve.
13-20	R1 councils. Give six article options. Lock council orders, Warrant and provisional signatures.
20-26	Resolve; announce causes and state. Post R2 articles. Remaining time is free discussion.
26-31	R2 factions. Return surviving assets. Show current duties. Deal one selected vision; lock reserve.
31-38	R2 councils under provisional powers. No article changes. Lock orders and Warrant.
38-44	Resolve and announce. Players negotiate final settlement.
44-54	Ceremony. Give settlement sheet. Warn at 52; check all five approvals at 54.
54-60	Read ending; use the six debrief prompts.

What to adjudicate

Apply only printed outcomes. Clarify terms without advising a strategy. No invented combat, negotiation bonus, prophecy, replacement asset or retroactive action. Both factions have shared objectives. Let each explain an unconventional political bargain, but it changes no printed cost.

This revision has been desk-checked. It has not had a fresh six-agent simulation or a human timing test. Resolution is more involved than v0.1; use the numbered sequence and record actual elapsed time.

Resolution sequence

FACILITATOR ONLY | USE OPENING READINESS THROUGHOUT

Record: opening Beacon/Communities/Readiness, asset condition, assignments, articles, both authorised orders, Warrant and reserve. Missing faction signatures use the player-guide defaults. Absent assets cannot be offered.

1. Authority, Warrant and Guard

Invalid, missing or unsigned council orders become Hold/Restraint, without penalty. Check Warrant first: Interim/M-I + opening Readiness 3+ + offered Vigil. Valid: guarded, Communities +1, Vigil spent. Under those articles but unsupported: Communities -1. Outside those articles: no effect. Then fund Guard with offered, unused Vigil; otherwise Restraint and Communities -1. A funded Guard gives guarded and Communities +1.

2. Fund Navigation and prepare Beacon

Costs: Relief/Military Wayfarer; Shared Wayfarer + Lantern; Repair Lantern; Hold none. A lodged Relief lift replaces missing offered Wayfarer for Relief only; spend Grey Petrel now. Otherwise an unfunded order becomes Hold and Communities -1. Add Maintain +1 or funded Repair +2 to Beacon, cap at 4. Record this **prepared Beacon**.

3. Resolve council passage and independent Trade

Relief/Military/Shared crosses only at prepared Beacon 2+. If halted: no cargo/passage, Communities -1, no wear. If crossed: Relief C+2; Military enables Campaign; Shared C+1 and enables Campaign. Record one wear per crossing. Check Trade against that same prepared Beacon: below 2, halt intact; at 2 unguarded, disable Wayfarer with no contract; otherwise complete one contract. Any Trade crossing, even attacked, adds one wear.

4. Check duties and military operations

Use the duty table on p. 3; each faction can lose C1 once for breaches. Fund Campaign/Raid only from **offered Spear**. Missing Spear: Restraint and C-1. An independent Spear Raid still resolves separately. Campaign without delivered Military/Shared passage: C-1, no fight, Spear intact. With passage: C-1, then opening Readiness 2+ means combat; below 2 disables Spear.

Raid always gives C-1. Check the round's hidden target condition (p. 4). Present at opening Readiness 2+: combat and another C-1. Present below 2: disable Spear, no further C loss. Absent: no combat, Spear intact. A council order cannot cancel an independent assignment.

5. Hidden effects, reserve and final tracks

Apply every applicable hidden row on p. 4, whether seen or not. Tender cover can prevent only the R1 crew loss. Spend it only if that trigger occurs. Return any untriggered intervention. Spent reserve never returns.

Final Beacon = prepared Beacon minus total wear, limited 0-4. Final Communities = opening value -1 consumption + all accumulated changes, limited 0-4 once. Final Readiness = opening value +1 if there was successful combat, otherwise -1, limited 0-4. Post permanent asset changes and completed contracts.

6. Announce and change authority

Explain what resolved, why it succeeded or failed, and what was lost. After R1 only, enact each correctly signed article for R2; otherwise that domain stays Interim. The new duties never apply retrospectively. Clear assignments next round; restore only surviving assets.

Public consequence tables

FACILITATOR ONLY | COMPLETE ORDINARY EFFECTS

Action	Asset / requirement	Effect
Maintain	Lantern kept by Guild	Prepared B+1
Repair	Offered Lantern	Prepared B+2
Relief	Offered Wayfarer; prepared B2+	C+2; one wear
Military	Offered Wayfarer; prepared B2+	Military passage; one wear
Shared	Offered Wayfarer + Lantern; B2+	C+1; military passage; one wear
Hold / Stand down / Home	No action	No direct benefit
Trade	Private Wayfarer; B3+ or B2 guarded	1 contract; one wear
Trade at B2, unguarded	Private Wayfarer	Disabled; no contract; one wear
Trade at B0-1	Private Wayfarer	Halt intact; no contract/wear
Guard / valid Warrant	Offered Vigil, once	C+1; guarded
Campaign	Offered Spear + military passage	C-1; opening R2+ combat; else Spear disabled
Raid, independent or council	Assigned Spear; target condition	C-1; target + R2+: combat and C-1 more; target + R0-1: Spear disabled
No successful combat	Any reason	R-1
Successful combat	Campaign or Raid	R+1, once
Consumption	Every round	C-1

Failure	Consequence
Missing required offered asset	Hold/Restraint; C-1; no reassignment
Council passage at prepared B0-1	Halt; C-1; no cargo, military passage or wear
Campaign without military passage	No departure; C-1; no combat; Spear intact
Unsupported Warrant under Interim/M-I	No protection; C-1
Missing/invalid authority	Hold/Restraint; no penalty for invalidity alone

Article	Duty; failure is C-1 per faction per round
Interim N / M	Guild: none. Army: no independent Raid.
N-G	Lantern Maintain or funded council Repair.
N-I or N-J	Wayfarer offered to Navigation, even if idle.
M-I or M-J	Spear offered to Security, even if idle.
M-A	Vigil Home. Independent Raid permitted.

B = Beacon; C = Communities; R = Readiness. Duties apply even if an asset has been lost or disabled. Breach is never an action veto. Defaults, operating costs, consumption and breaches stack. Full public descriptions appear in the player pack.

Hidden consequences

FACILITATOR ONLY | APPLY EVEN WHEN THE VISION WAS NOT READ

Round one

Condition	Fixed consequence
Shared voyage crosses without Guard/Warrant	Lantern's navigation team is killed at an exposed transfer berth by remnant saboteurs. Remove Lantern permanently. A lodged Tender cover spends Grey Petrel to prevent this loss. This is a physical attack; the cutter does not change Beacon.
Any Raid: target presence	The remnant detachment appears only if Wayfarer's private Trade completes a contract this round. Otherwise it remains concealed. Apply the public Raid strength and cost rules.

Round two

Condition	Fixed consequence
Military voyage crosses without Guard/Warrant	Military-only loading leaves local stores exposed: Communities -1. Grey Petrel Tender cover cannot prevent this.
Funded Repair + completed private Trade	The repaired relay and commercial food sellers support local distribution: Communities +1. A halted or attacked Trade does not qualify.
Any Raid: target presence	The detachment appears only if a Relief voyage crosses this round, including a Grey Petrel Relief lift. Shared cargo does not qualify: the detachment avoids a convoy carrying the cohort. Apply the public Raid strength and cost rules.

No other hidden rules

R1 and R2 rules apply only in their named round. Target presence is evaluated after passage and Trade, not from intentions. A Raid still needs Spear and opening Readiness 2+ to produce successful combat. At Beacon 0, a Repair with Trade can still make the R2 Navigation benefit reachable; there is no uncovered middle Beacon value.

The remnant has different movements in the two months. The visions reveal operational intelligence about those movements and their consequences. They do not reveal the complete scientific mechanism of veterans' returning perceptions or certify a rehabilitation programme.

Foresight handling

Deal one chosen card at each faction phase. Let the Ascendant retain, show or quote it. Clarify the exact trigger. Never disclose the other card or suggest an order. The four cards are complete: their unseen consequences still apply. If a condition is avoided, do not invent a replacement disaster.

What has deliberately been adapted

This local scenario requires successful combat to sustain conditioning. The original larger game also allowed properly resourced deployment and internal trials. The narrower eligibility is printed as a prototype rule. It is not a claim that the old lore established that exact restriction.

Guild licences and their fourteen-year petition remain in the briefs. The deeper mysteries, veteran-training programme, succession politics and wider communications rights remain outside this two-instrument exercise. No rapid conversion of veterans into navigators is available.

Four private visions

CUT INTO FOUR | DEAL ONLY THE CHOSEN CARD

R1 NAVIGATION | The open berth

Soldiers can secure a landing place. They cannot teach a dead navigator what the deep is saying.

If Shared passage crosses without Guard or a valid Warrant: remnant saboteurs kill Lantern's navigation team at the transfer berth. Lantern is permanently unavailable.

If guarded: the attack is prevented. A lodged Grey Petrel Tender cover also prevents the loss and is spent if needed. It adds no Communities or Beacon.

If Shared does not cross: this consequence does not occur. Normal passage, wear and military rules still apply.

R1 SECURITY | The commercial lure

The remnant is watching the merchants. An army sent to an empty berth will find only its own footsteps.

If Wayfarer completes a private commercial contract: the local remnant detachment appears. Any properly assigned Raid meets it; at opening Readiness 2+ there is successful combat.

Otherwise: any Raid misses the target. It still costs Communities -1, but produces no combat and does not disable Spear.

Public limits: a present target below Readiness 2 disables Spear. Successful Raid costs Communities -2 total. Apply one Readiness +1 for combat, otherwise -1.

R2 NAVIGATION | Who gets the stores?

A ship can arrive and still leave the people waiting. A repaired signal can bring merchants to a berth they would otherwise pass.

If Military passage crosses without Guard or valid Warrant: exposed local stores are stripped during military-only loading. Communities -1 in addition to all other effects.

If Repair is funded and Wayfarer completes private Trade: commercial distribution uses the repaired relay. Communities +1 in addition to all other effects.

Otherwise: neither extra effect applies. Use actual completed voyages and funded Repair, not promises. These conditions have no opening-Beacon gap.

R2 SECURITY | The relief ships

Last month's target has learned. It will approach relief traffic, but will not approach a convoy carrying your cohort.

If a Relief voyage crosses: the remnant detachment appears. A properly assigned Raid meets it. Grey Petrel Relief lift qualifies.

If there is no delivered Relief: the Raid misses. Shared and Military passage do not draw this detachment out.

Public limits: target present + opening Readiness 2+: combat and Communities -2 total. Present below 2: Spear disabled, C-1. Absent: C-1, no combat, intact. Combat gives Readiness +1; otherwise -1.

Worked cooperation

FACILITATOR ONLY | EXAMPLE, NOT A STRATEGY HANDOUT

Round one: a supported mixed voyage

Start **B2 / C3 / R3**. Guild offers both ships. Janissariat offers both formations. Ascendant selects Shared and Campaign, and issues a valid Warrant using Vigil. All three parties agree N-J and M-J for round two.

Step	Result
Warrant	Offered Vigil + opening R3: guarded, C+1.
Navigation	Both ships pay Shared. Prepared B2: crosses, C+1 and military passage; one wear.
Campaign	Offered Spear + passage + opening R3: combat, C-1.
Hidden effect	Shared berth is guarded: no crew loss.
Final	Beacon 2-1 = 1. Communities 3-1 consumption +1 Warrant +1 Shared -1 Campaign = 3. Readiness 3+1 = 4. Contracts 0.

Round two: relief and restraint

Under **N-J/M-J**, Guild offers Wayfarer and uses Lantern Maintain. Janissariat offers Spear and Vigil. Both councils agree: Relief and Guard. No Warrant is available to the Ascendant under M-J. Spear remains idle; offered does not mean compelled to fight.

Step	Result
Prepare	Beacon 1+1 Maintain = 2.
Navigation	Relief crosses: C+2, one wear.
Security	Guard uses Vigil: C+1. No successful combat.
Duties	Wayfarer and Spear offered: both duties met.
Final	Beacon 2-1 = 1. Communities 3-1+2+1 = 5, capped at 4. Readiness 4-1 = 3. All assets intact; Contracts 0; reserve unused.

The price of that bargain

Guild: both commercial contracts forgone; Beacon finishes below its preferred 2; sole discretion surrendered.
Janissariat: one peaceful round costs conditioned power; future lawful fighting needs Guild consent; military autonomy surrendered.
Ascendant: both operational powers shared and the independent Warrant lost. The army remains capable, but is no longer available on the same terms.

This example shows survival with concessions. It does not establish an optimal or balanced strategy. The players may value different powers more highly. If they ratify another package, explain its future duties without applying another month of effects.

Edge cases and the ending

FACILITATOR ONLY | USE THESE RULINGS

Case	Exact ruling
Withheld assets and directives	Trade/Maintain and Stand down/Home leave Shared and Campaign unfunded. Each order defaults with C-1. An unsupported Interim Warrant adds C-1. Private Trade may still succeed; no assets are seized.
Contradictory instructions	The final valid council card supersedes earlier imperial notes. An invalid council order defaults without penalty for invalidity alone. A valid Warrant uses Vigil before any council Guard; a second claim fails with C-1.
Averted prophecy	R1 Shared without Guard normally loses Lantern. Lodged Tender cover spends Grey Petrel and keeps the crew alive. It leaves Beacon wear, Campaign and Communities unchanged.
Independent risk/reward	R1 Trade + Maintain gives prepared B3 and a completed contract. Independent Raid then fights at opening R3: Readiness rises to 4. With Vigil Home and no council action, C3 becomes 0: consumption -1, Raid -2, Interim breach -1. Replace private Trade with Relief and the same Raid misses.
Two peaceful supplied rounds	Opening R3 falls to 2 then 1 even if Relief and Guard succeed. In round two the R2 opening value cannot support a Warrant.
Grey Petrel and Trade together	Relief lift may replace unoffered Wayfarer while Wayfarer Trades. Check both at prepared Beacon. Two crossing ships cause two wear. The cutter cannot provide Shared or Military lift.
Deadlock and absent cards	Use printed defaults. Broken duties still cost C-1. A faction is never eliminated, even with all its operational assets absent.
Failed ratification	Any missing player approval means neither final instrument is enacted. Both provisional articles expire. Interim returns, but no asset, track or contract is restored.

Describe the ending

Beacon: 0 closed; 1 fragile and unable to carry a voyage before work; 2 serviceable; 3-4 robust.
Communities: 0 local settlement in revolt and scarcity; 1 desperate; 2 surviving; 3-4 supplied with growing confidence.
Readiness: 0 no coherent local conditioned force; 1 weak and questioning; 2 capable but insufficient for an imperial Warrant; 3-4 strong military support, subject to the powers actually ratified.

State lost or disabled assets and unfulfilled contracts separately. Fraying is loss of conditioned combat power, not a judgement that the soldiers becoming more human is bad. No ending compels betrayal or invents successful veteran rehabilitation.

What the checks establish

The accompanying design note records the current desk checks and their limits. Before another simulation, read both packs as a set. During a human test, time resolution and ask whether each player understood their own two cards. If not, reduce exceptional effects before adding more assets.